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Week 4 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: THE MIDDLE TERM OF FUTURE DANGER

Purpose: Apply Week 4's Whately method to Julius Caesar. Map practical syllogisms and test whether the middle term really connects the premises to the conclusion.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Quote briefly if useful. Your job is to map the reasoning, not retell the scene.

Part 1: Brutus's Main Argument

Question 1.1

In the serpent's egg passage, what conclusion is Brutus trying to justify? State it as a clear sentence.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

Write one possible major premise and one possible minor premise behind Brutus's argument.

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Terms in the Syllogism

Question 2.1

For Brutus's argument, name the minor term, major term, and middle term. Use ordinary language, not just S, P, and M.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Which premise is the pressure point: the major premise or the minor premise? Explain what Brutus would need to prove.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Cassius's Argument

Question 3.1

What conclusion does Cassius want Brutus to reach about Caesar or Rome? State one possible conclusion clearly.

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Choose one possible middle term in Cassius's argument. Explain whether Cassius proves that Caesar belongs under that term.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Comparing the Arguments

Question 4.1

Which argument is more logically disciplined: Brutus's serpent's egg argument or Cassius's Colossus argument? Use the terms premise, conclusion, and middle term in your answer.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Put Whately's Week 4 question to the play: when a speaker argues from possible future danger, what middle term must be proved before violent prevention follows?

Part 4 Q2